

Schools of Hope Resources

School of Hope Overview

Source:<https://www.fldoe.org/schools/school-choice/other-school-choice-options/schools-of-hope/>

School of Hope

A charter school operated by a hope operator which serves students from one or more persistently low-performing schools; is located in the attendance zone of a persistently low-performing school or within a 5-mile radius of such school, whichever is greater; and is a Title I eligible school.

Hope Operator

A hope operator is a nonprofit organization with tax exempt status under s. 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code that operates three or more charter schools that serve students in grades K-12 in Florida or other states with a record of serving students from low-income families and is designated by the State Board of Education as a hope operator based on a determination that:

1. The past performance of the hope operator meets or exceeds the following criteria:
 1. The achievement of enrolled students exceeds the district and state averages of the states in which the operator's schools operate;
 2. The average college attendance rate at all schools currently operated by the operator exceeds 80 percent, if such data is available;
 3. The percentage of students eligible for a free or reduced price lunch under the National School Lunch Act enrolled at all schools currently operated by the operator exceeds 70 percent;
 4. The operator is in good standing with the authorizer in each state in which it operates;
 5. The audited financial statements of the operator are free of material misstatements and going concern issues; and
 6. Other outcome measures as determined by the State Board of Education;
2. The operator was awarded a United States Department of Education Charter School Program Grant for Replication and Expansion of High-Quality Charter Schools within the preceding 3 years before applying to be a hope operator;
3. The operator receives funding through the National Fund of the Charter School Growth Fund to accelerate the growth of the nation's best charter schools; or
4. The operator is selected by a district school board in accordance with s. [1002.333](#).

The six Florida designated hope operators are: [Mater Academy](#), [RCMA](#), [IDEA Public Schools](#), [Success Academy](#), [Renaissance/Warrington Preparatory Academy](#), and [KIPP New Jersey](#).
[Revolving Loan Fund Data & Information](#)

Schools of Hope Statute

Source: https://www.leg.state.fl.us/statutes/index.cfm?App_mode=Display_Statute&Search_String=&URL=1000-1099/1002/Sections/1002.333.html

1002.333 Persistently low-performing schools.—

(1) DEFINITIONS.—As used in this section, the term:

(a) “Florida Opportunity Zone” means a population census tract that has been designated by the United States Department of the Treasury as a Qualified Opportunity Zone pursuant to s. 1400Z-1(b)(1)(B) of the Internal Revenue Code.

(b) “Hope operator” means an entity identified by the department pursuant to subsection (2).

(c) “Persistently low-performing school” means a school that meets at least one of the following criteria:

1. A school that has earned three grades lower than a “C,” pursuant to s. [1008.34](#), in at least 3 of the previous 5 years that the school received a grade and has not earned a grade of “B” or higher in the most recent 2 school years;

2. A school that was closed pursuant to s. [1008.33](#)(4) within 2 years after the submission of a notice of intent; or

3. A school in the bottom 10 percent in at least 2 of the previous 3 years for student performance on the end-of-year administration of the coordinated screening and progress monitoring system for grade 3 English Language Arts or grade 4 mathematics as prescribed in s. [1008.22](#)(3)(a)2.

(d) “School of hope” means:

1. A charter school operated by a hope operator which:

a. Serves students from one or more persistently low-performing schools or students who reside in a Florida Opportunity Zone;

b. Is located in a Florida Opportunity Zone or in the attendance zone of a persistently low-performing school or within a 5-mile radius of such school, whichever is greater. A school of hope may be located outside of a Florida Opportunity Zone or persistently low-performing school attendance zone if the school district does not have underused, vacant, or surplus property available for the hope operator to use within a Florida Opportunity Zone or persistently low-performing school attendance zone; and

c. Is a Title I eligible school; or

2. A school operated by a hope operator pursuant to s. [1008.33](#)(4)(b)3.

(2) HOPE OPERATOR.—A hope operator is a nonprofit organization with tax exempt status under s. 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code that operates three or more charter schools that serve students in grades K-12 in Florida or other states with a record of serving students from low-income

families and is designated by the State Board of Education as a hope operator based on a determination that:

(a) The past performance of the hope operator meets or exceeds the following criteria:

1. The achievement of enrolled students exceeds the district and state averages of the states in which the operator's schools operate;
2. The average college attendance rate at all schools currently operated by the operator exceeds 80 percent, if such data is available;
3. The percentage of students eligible for a free or reduced price lunch under the National School Lunch Act enrolled at all schools currently operated by the operator exceeds 70 percent;
4. The operator is in good standing with the authorizer in each state in which it operates;
5. The audited financial statements of the operator are free of material misstatements and going concern issues; and
6. Other outcome measures as determined by the State Board of Education;

(b) The operator was awarded a United States Department of Education Charter School Program Grant for Replication and Expansion of High-Quality Charter Schools within the preceding 3 years before applying to be a hope operator;

(c) The operator receives funding through the National Fund of the Charter School Growth Fund to accelerate the growth of the nation's best charter schools; or

(d) The operator is selected by a district school board in accordance with s. [1008.33](#).

An entity that meets the requirements of paragraph (b), paragraph (c), or paragraph (d) before the adoption by the state board of measurable criteria pursuant to paragraph (a) shall be designated as a hope operator. After the adoption of the measurable criteria, an entity, including a governing board that operates a school established pursuant to s. [1008.33](#)(4)(b)3., shall be designated as a hope operator if it meets the criteria of paragraph (a).

(3) DESIGNATION OF HOPE OPERATOR.—Initial status as a hope operator is valid for 5 years from the opening of a school of hope. If a hope operator seeks the renewal of its status, such renewal shall solely be based upon the academic and financial performance of all schools established by the operator in the state since its initial designation.

(4) ESTABLISHMENT OF SCHOOLS OF HOPE.—A hope operator seeking to open a school of hope must submit an application to a state university or a Florida College System institution or a notice of intent to a school district to establish a school of hope. If a hope operator seeks to open a school of hope through an agreement with a state university or a Florida College System institution, a notice of intent must be provided to the school district in which a persistently low-performing school has been identified by the State Board of Education pursuant to subsection (10) or in which a Florida Opportunity Zone is located.

(a) The notice of intent must include:

1. An academic focus and plan.
2. A financial plan.
3. Goals and objectives for increasing student achievement for the students from low-income families.
4. A completed or planned community outreach plan.
5. The organizational history of success in working with students with similar demographics.
6. The grade levels to be served and enrollment projections.
7. The proposed location or geographic area proposed for the school consistent with the requirements of sub-subparagraphs (1)(d)1.a. and b.
8. A staffing plan.

(b) Notwithstanding the requirements of s. [1002.33](#), a school district, state university, or Florida College System institution, as applicable, shall enter into a performance-based agreement with a hope operator to open schools to serve students from persistently low-performing schools and students residing in a Florida Opportunity Zone.

(5) PERFORMANCE-BASED AGREEMENT.—The following shall comprise the entirety of the performance-based agreement:

(a) The notice of intent, which is incorporated by reference and attached to the agreement.

(b) The location or geographic area proposed for the school of hope and its proximity to the persistently low-performing school, as applicable.

(c) An enumeration of the grades to be served in each year of the agreement and whether the school will serve children in the school readiness or prekindergarten programs.

(d) A plan of action and specific milestones for student recruitment and the enrollment of students from persistently low-performing schools and students residing in a Florida Opportunity Zone, including enrollment preferences and procedures for conducting transparent admissions lotteries that are open to the public. For the entire validity period of the performance agreement, students from persistently low-performing schools and students residing in a Florida Opportunity Zone must receive an enrollment preference and shall be exempt from any enrollment lottery to the extent permitted by federal grant requirements.

(e) A delineation of the current incoming baseline standard of student academic achievement, the outcomes to be achieved, and the method of measurement that will be used.

(f) A description of the methods of involving parents and expected levels for such involvement.

(g) The grounds for termination, including failure to meet the requirements for student performance established pursuant to paragraph (e), generally accepted standards of fiscal management, or material violation of terms of the agreement. The nonrenewal or termination of a performance-based agreement must comply with the requirements of s. [1002.33](#)(8).

(h) A provision allowing the hope operator to open additional schools to serve students enrolled in or zoned for a persistently low-performing school and students residing in a Florida Opportunity Zone if the hope operator maintains its status under subsection (3).

(i) A provision establishing the initial term as 5 years. The agreement shall be renewed, upon the request of the hope operator, unless the school fails to meet the requirements for student performance established pursuant to paragraph (e) or generally accepted standards of fiscal management or the school of hope materially violates the law or the terms of the agreement.

(j) A requirement to provide transportation consistent with the requirements of ss. [1006.21](#)-[1006.27](#) and s. [1012.45](#). The governing body of the school of hope may provide transportation through an agreement or contract with the district school board, a private provider, or parents of enrolled students. Transportation may not be a barrier to equal access for all students residing within reasonable distance of the school.

(k) A requirement that any arrangement entered into to borrow or otherwise secure funds for the school of hope from a source other than the state, a state university, a Florida College System institution, or a school district shall indemnify the state, state university, Florida College System institution, and school district from any and all liability, including, but not limited to, financial responsibility for the payment of the principal or interest.

(l) A provision that any loans, bonds, or other financial agreements are not obligations of the state, state university, Florida College System institution, or school district but are obligations of the school of hope and are payable solely from the sources of funds pledged by such agreement.

(m) A prohibition on the pledge of credit or taxing power of the state, state university, Florida College System institution, or school district.

(6) STATUTORY AUTHORITY.—

(a) A school of hope or a nonprofit entity that operates more than one school of hope through a performance-based agreement with a school district, state university, or Florida College System institution, as applicable, may be designated as a local education agency by the department, if requested, for the purposes of receiving federal funds and, in doing so, accepts the full responsibility for all local education agency requirements and the schools for which it will perform local education agency responsibilities.

1. A nonprofit entity designated as a local education agency may directly report its students to the department in accordance with the definitions in s. [1011.61](#) and pursuant to the department's procedures and timelines.

2. Students enrolled in a school established by a hope operator designated as a local educational agency are not eligible students for purposes of calculating the district grade pursuant to s. [1008.34](#)(5).

(b) For the purposes of tort liability, the hope operator, the school of hope, and its employees or agents shall be governed by s. [768.28](#). The sponsor shall not be liable for civil damages under state law for the employment actions or personal injury, property damage, or death resulting from an act or omission of a hope operator, the school of hope, or its employees or agents. This paragraph does not include any for-profit entity contracted by the charter school or its governing body.

(c) A school of hope may be either a private or a public employer. As a public employer, the school of hope may participate in the Florida Retirement System upon application and approval as a covered group under s. [121.021](#)(34). If a school of hope participates in the Florida Retirement System, the school of hope's employees shall be compulsory members of the Florida Retirement System.

(d) A hope operator may employ school administrators and instructional personnel who do not meet the requirements of s. [1012.56](#) if the school administrators and instructional personnel are not ineligible for such employment under s. [1012.315](#).

(e) Compliance with s. [1003.03](#) shall be calculated as the average at the school level.

(f) Schools of hope operated by a hope operator shall be exempt from chapters 1000-1013 and all school board policies. However, a hope operator shall be in compliance with the laws in chapters 1000-1013 relating to:

1. The student assessment program and school grading system.
2. Student progression and graduation.
3. The provision of services to students with disabilities.
4. Civil rights, including s. [1000.05](#), relating to discrimination.
5. Student health, safety, and welfare.
6. Public meetings and records, public inspection, and criminal and civil penalties pursuant to s. [286.011](#). The governing board of a school of hope must hold at least two public meetings per school year in the school district in which the school of hope is located. Any other meetings of the governing board may be held in accordance with s. [120.54](#)(5)(b)2.
7. Public records pursuant to chapter 119.
8. The code of ethics for public officers and employees pursuant to ss. [112.313](#)(2), (3), (7), and (12) and [112.3143](#)(3).

(g) Each school of hope that has not been designated as a local education agency shall report its students to the school district as required in s. [1011.62](#), and in accordance with the definitions in s. [1011.61](#). The school district shall include each charter school's enrollment in the district's report of student enrollment. All charter schools submitting student record information required by the department shall comply with the department's guidelines for electronic data formats for such data, and all districts shall accept electronic data that complies with the department's electronic format.

(h)1. A school of hope shall provide the school district, state university, or Florida College System institution, as applicable, with a concise, uniform, quarterly financial statement summary sheet that contains a balance sheet and a statement of revenue, expenditures, and changes in fund balance. The balance sheet and the statement of revenue, expenditures, and changes in fund balance shall be in the governmental fund format prescribed by the Governmental Accounting Standards Board. Additionally, a school of hope shall comply with the annual audit requirement for charter schools in s. [218.39](#).

2. A school of hope is in compliance with subparagraph 1. if it is operated by a nonprofit entity designated as a local education agency and if the nonprofit submits to each school district, state university, or Florida College System institution, as applicable, in which it operates a school of hope:

a. A concise, uniform, quarterly financial statement summary sheet that contains a balance sheet summarizing the revenue, expenditures, and changes in fund balance for the entity and for its schools of hope within the school district.

b. An annual financial audit of the nonprofit which includes all schools of hope it operates within this state and which complies with s. [218.39](#) regarding audits of a school board.

(7) FACILITIES.—

(a) A school of hope shall use facilities that comply with the Florida Building Code, except for the State Requirements for Educational Facilities. A school of hope that uses school district facilities must comply with the State Requirements for Educational Facilities only if the school district and the hope operator have entered into a mutual management plan for the reasonable maintenance of such facilities. The mutual management plan shall contain a provision by which the district school board agrees to maintain the school facilities in the same manner as its other public schools within the district. A school of hope may colocate with another school in a public school facility. The school district must permit any school of hope to use all or part of underused, vacant, or surplus school district facilities, and receive facility-related services, pursuant to State Board of Education rule. Students enrolled in the school of hope shall be included in the district's total capital outlay full-time equivalent membership for the purpose of s. [1013.62](#) and for calculating the Public Education Capital Outlay maintenance funds or any other maintenance funds for the facility. The local governing authority shall not adopt or impose any local building requirements or site-development restrictions, such as parking and site-size criteria, student enrollment, and occupant load, that are addressed by and more stringent than those found in the State Requirements for Educational Facilities of the Florida Building Code. A local governing authority must treat schools of hope equitably in comparison to similar requirements, restrictions, and site planning processes imposed upon public schools. The agency having jurisdiction for inspection of a facility and issuance of a certificate of occupancy or use shall be the local municipality or, if in an unincorporated area, the county governing authority. If an official or employee of the local governing authority refuses to comply with this paragraph, the aggrieved school or entity has an immediate right to bring an action in circuit court to enforce its rights by injunction. An aggrieved party that receives injunctive relief may be awarded reasonable attorney fees and court costs.

(b) Any facility, or portion thereof, used to house a school of hope shall be exempt from ad valorem taxes pursuant to s. [196.1983](#). Library, community service, museum, performing arts, theater, cinema, church, Florida College System institution, college, and university facilities may provide space to schools of hope within their facilities under their preexisting zoning and land use designations without obtaining a special exception, rezoning, or a land use change.

(c) School of hope facilities are exempt from assessments of fees for building permits, except as provided in s. [553.80](#); fees for building and occupational licenses; impact fees or exactions; service availability fees; and assessments for special benefits.

(d) No later than January 1, the department shall annually provide to school districts a list of all underused, vacant, or surplus facilities owned or operated by the school district as reported in the Florida Inventory of School Houses. A school district may provide evidence to the department that a facility includes prekindergarten students who are not reported for funding in the Florida Education Finance Program or that the list contains errors or omissions within 30 days after receipt of the list. By each April 1, the department shall update and publish a final list of all underused, vacant, or surplus facilities owned or operated by each school district, based upon updated information provided by each school district. A hope operator establishing a school of hope may use an educational facility identified in this paragraph at no cost. A hope operator using a facility pursuant to this paragraph may not sell or dispose of such facility without the written permission of the school district. For purposes of this paragraph, the term “underused, vacant, or surplus facility” means an entire facility or portion thereof which is not fully used or is used irregularly or intermittently by the school district for instructional or program use.

(8) **NONCOMPLIANCE.**—A school district that does not enter into a performance-based agreement within 60 days after receipt of a notice of intent shall reduce the administrative fees withheld pursuant to s. [1002.33](#)(20) to 1 percent for all charter schools operating in the school district. Upon execution of the performance-based agreement, the school district may resume withholding the full amount of administrative fees, but may not recover any fees that would have otherwise accrued during the period of noncompliance. Any charter school that had administrative fees withheld in violation of this subsection may recover attorney fees and costs to enforce the requirements of this subsection. A school district subject to the requirements of this section shall file a monthly report detailing the reduction in the amount of administrative fees withheld.

(9) **FUNDING.**—

(a) Schools of hope shall be funded in accordance with s. [1002.33](#)(17).

(b) Schools of hope shall receive priority in the department’s Public Charter School Grant Program competitions.

(c) Schools of hope shall be considered charter schools for purposes of s. [1013.62](#), except charter capital outlay may not be used to purchase real property or for the construction of school facilities.

(d) Schools of hope are eligible to receive funds from the Schools of Hope Program.

(e) For a nonprofit entity designated by the department as a local education agency pursuant to paragraph (6)(h), any unrestricted current and capital assets identified in the annual financial audit required by sub-subparagraph (6)(h)2.b. may be used for any other school of hope operated by the local education agency within the same district. Unrestricted current assets shall be used in accordance with s. [1011.62](#), and any unrestricted capital assets shall be used in accordance with s. [1013.62](#)(2).

(10) **SCHOOLS OF HOPE PROGRAM.**—The Schools of Hope Program is created within the Department of Education.

(a) A school of hope is eligible to receive funds from the Schools of Hope Program for the following expenditures:

1. Preparing teachers, school leaders, and specialized instructional support personnel, including costs associated with:

a. Providing professional learning.

b. Hiring and compensating teachers, school leaders, and specialized instructional support personnel for services until the school reaches full enrollment in accordance with the performance-based agreement pursuant to subsection (5).

2. Acquiring supplies, training, equipment, and educational materials, including developing and acquiring instructional materials.

3. Providing one-time startup costs associated with providing transportation to students to and from the charter school.
4. Carrying out community engagement activities, which may include paying the cost of student and staff recruitment.
5. Providing funds to cover the nonvoted ad valorem millage that would otherwise be required for schools and the required local effort funds calculated pursuant to s. [1011.62](#) when the state board enters into an agreement with a hope operator pursuant to subsection (5).
6. Providing funds for the initial leasing costs of a school facility in the event the department determines that a suitable district-owned facility is unavailable or not leased in a timely manner pursuant to paragraph (7)(d).

In the event a school of hope is dissolved or is otherwise terminated, all property, furnishings, and equipment purchased with public funds shall automatically revert to full ownership by the district school board, subject to complete satisfaction of any lawful liens or encumbrances. Any unencumbered public funds from the school of hope, district school board property and improvements, furnishings, and equipment purchased with public funds, or financial or other records pertaining to the school of hope, in the possession of any person, entity, or holding company, other than the charter school, shall be held in trust upon the district school board's request, until any appeal status is resolved.

(b) A school of hope may continue to receive funds after its first 5 years of operation if the school of hope meets performance metrics established pursuant to state board rule. Funds received based upon performance may be used for any operational expenditures.

(c) Notwithstanding s. [216.301](#) and pursuant to s. [216.351](#), funds allocated for the purpose of this subsection which are not disbursed by June 30 of the fiscal year in which the funds are allocated may be carried forward for up to 5 years after the effective date of the original appropriation.

(11) STATE BOARD OF EDUCATION AUTHORITY AND OBLIGATIONS.—Pursuant to Art. IX of the State Constitution, which prescribes the duty of the State Board of Education to supervise the public school system, the State Board of Education shall:

(a) Publish an annual list of persistently low-performing schools after the release of preliminary school grades.

(b) Adopt a standard notice of intent and performance-based agreement that must be used by hope operators and district school boards to eliminate regulatory and bureaucratic barriers that delay access to high quality schools for students in persistently low-performing schools and students residing in Florida Opportunity Zones.

(c) Resolve disputes between a hope operator and a school district, state university, or Florida College System institution, as applicable, arising from a performance-based agreement, mutual management plan, or contract between a charter operator and a school district under the requirements of s. [1008.33](#). The Commissioner of Education shall appoint a special magistrate who is a member of The Florida Bar in good standing and who has at least 5 years' experience in administrative law. The special magistrate shall hold hearings to determine facts relating to the dispute and to render a recommended decision for resolution to the State Board of Education. The recommendation may not alter in any way the provisions of the performance-based agreement under subsection (5). The special magistrate may administer oaths and issue subpoenas on behalf of the parties to the dispute or on his or her own behalf. Within 15 calendar days after the close of the final hearing, the special magistrate shall transmit a recommended decision to the State Board of Education and to the representatives of both parties by registered mail, return receipt requested. The State Board of Education must approve or reject the recommended decision at its next regularly scheduled meeting that is more than 7 calendar days and no more than 30 days after the date the recommended decision

is transmitted. The decision by the State Board of Education is a final agency action that may be appealed to the District Court of Appeal, First District in accordance with s. [120.68](#). A charter school may recover attorney fees and costs if the State Board of Education determines that the school district unlawfully implemented or otherwise impeded implementation of the performance-based agreement pursuant to this paragraph.

(d) Provide students in persistently low-performing schools and students residing in Florida Opportunity Zones with a public school that meets accountability standards. The State Board of Education may enter into a performance-based agreement with a hope operator when a school district has not improved the school after 3 years of the interventions and support provided under s. [1008.33](#) or has not complied with the requirements of subsection (4). Upon the State Board of Education entering into a performance-based agreement with a hope operator, the school district shall transfer to the school of hope the proportionate share of state funds allocated from the Florida Education Finance Program.

(12) SCHOOLS OF HOPE REPORTING.—

(a) In addition to the information reported in s. [1002.33](#)(9)(k), each school of hope must report to its sponsor:

1. The number of students served, and the percentage of overall school enrollment, who reside in the attendance zone of the persistently low-performing school or in a Florida Opportunity Zone.
2. Student year-to-year reenrollment within kindergarten through grade 5, grades 6-8, and grades 9-12.

(b) The department shall annually provide to the State Board of Education, the Commissioner of Education, the Governor, the President of the Senate, and the Speaker of the House of Representatives a report on schools of hope which includes the information from paragraph (a) and the performance of school of hope students on statewide assessments under s. [1008.22](#)(3) compared to assessment results of other Title I-eligible schools in the district.

(13) RULES.—The State Board of Education shall adopt rules pursuant to ss. [120.536](#)(1) and [120.54](#) to implement this section.

History.—s. 43, ch. 2017-116; s. 11, ch. 2018-6; s. 5, ch. 2019-23; s. 6, ch. 2021-35; s. 11, ch. 2023-220; s. 6, ch. 2024-5; s. 5, ch. 2025-203.

[Schools of Hope Rules](#)

Source: <https://flrules.org/gateway/ruleNo.asp?id=6A-1.0998271>

6A-1.0998271 Schools of Hope.

(1) Definitions: For the purpose of this rule, the following definitions apply.

(a) “Department” means the Florida Department of Education.

(b) “Entity” means a non-profit organization with tax exempt status under s. 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code that operates three (3) or more public charter schools that serve students in grades K-12 in Florida or other states with a record of serving students from low-income families.

(c) “Charter School Growth Fund” means the non-profit entity Charter Fund Inc., dba Charter School Growth Fund, whose federal employer identification number is 05-0620063.

(d) "National Fund" means the fund established in 2005 by the Charter School Growth Fund to accelerate the growth of the nation's best charter schools.

(e) "Hope Operator" means an entity that has been designated by the State Board of Education as a Hope Operator pursuant to Section 1002.333(2), F.S.

(f) "Excess seats" means the difference between a facility's total student stations and the facility's total capital outlay full-time equivalent (COFTE) student enrollment according to the most recent student survey data. For purposes of determining whether a facility is an underused, vacant or surplus facility, Projected SOH Enrollment for a School of Hope that has submitted an approved SOH Notice of Intent for that facility shall not be deemed to be excess seats.

(g) "Projected SOH Enrollment" means the number of students that a Hope Operator projects for enrollment at a School of Hope following the first five years of its operations in a particular facility.

(h) "Underused, vacant or surplus facility" means an entire facility or portion thereof that is not fully used or is used irregularly or intermittently by the district for instructional or program use.

(i) "Fully used" means a facility that is using at least 90 percent or more of its student stations.

(j) "Vacant and Underused Facilities Report" means the report described in paragraph (5)(a).

(k) "Sponsor" means the district, Florida College System institution or state university that is the sponsor or authorizer of a School of Hope.

(l) "Florida Opportunity Zone" means a population census tract that has been designated by the United States Department of the Treasury as a Qualified Opportunity Zone pursuant to s. 1400Z-1(b)(1)(B) of the Internal Revenue Code.

(m) "Business day" means Monday through Friday, excluding legal holidays pursuant to Section 683.01, F.S., and days in which the district is closed due to a natural disaster.

(n) "Facility Utilization Rate" means the total capital outlay full-time equivalent (COFTE) student enrollment divided by the facility's total student stations pursuant to the most recent Florida Inventory of School Houses (FISH) report. Solely for the purpose of this calculation, students receiving Level IV or Level V supports through an individual educational plan who are educated in a self-contained classroom for exceptional student education at least 50 percent of the instructional day, shall account for 2.0 COFTE student enrollment.

(2) Process for designation as a Hope Operator.

(a) An entity may apply to the State Board of Education to request the Hope Operator designation.

(b) An entity shall be designated as a Hope Operator if it submits a complete application and meets the following criteria:

1. The achievement of enrolled students exceeds the district and state averages of the states in which the operator's schools operate;
2. The average college attendance rate at all high schools currently operated by the operator exceeds 80 percent;
3. The percentage of students eligible for a free or reduced price lunch under the National School Lunch Act enrolled at all schools currently operated by the operator exceeds 70 percent;
4. The operator is in good standing with the authorizer in each state in which it operates;
5. The audited financial statements of the operator are free of material misstatements and ongoing concerns.

(c) In addition to meeting the criteria in paragraph (b), an entity must meet at least one of the following criteria:

1. The entity was awarded a United States Department of Education Charter School Program grant for the Replication and Expansion of High-Quality Charter Schools pursuant to Title IV, Part C of the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965 as amended by the Every Student Succeeds Act (20

U.S.C. 7221-7221j) within the preceding three (3) years from the date the entity submits an application to the Department.

2. The entity has a current and active grant award for funding through the National Fund of the Charter School Growth Fund.

3. The entity is a non-profit charter school that is selected by a district school board to turnaround the performance of a low-performing public school pursuant to Section 1008.33, F.S.

(d) An entity requesting the Hope Operator designation must complete and submit form SOH1, Application for Hope Operator Designation, hereby incorporated by reference (<http://www.flrules.org/Gateway/reference.asp?No=Ref-09075>) effective February 2018, and all required supporting documentation identified in form SOH1, to the Department at the address in subsection (8) of this rule. Form SOH1 may be obtained electronically on the Department of Education's website at <http://www.floridaschoolschoice.org> or from the Office of Independent Education and Parental Choice, Department of Education, 325 West Gaines Street, Tallahassee, Florida 32399-0400.

(e) Upon receipt of the Application for Hope Operator Designation, the Department shall review and verify the information and may request additional information necessary for verification purposes. The Department shall provide written notice to the entity indicating the status of the application and the date of the State Board of Education meeting at which the State Board will consider the application.

(f) Upon the State Board of Education voting to designate the entity as a Hope Operator, the Department shall provide official notice to the entity of such designation. If the Application for Hope Operator Designation is denied, the State Board of Education shall articulate in writing the specific reasons supporting its denial of the application and shall provide the letter of denial to the entity.

(3) Establishing a School of Hope. An entity that has been designated as a Hope Operator pursuant to Section 1002.333(2), F.S., and subsection (2) of this rule may establish a School of Hope in a Florida Opportunity Zone or in the attendance zone or within a five (5) mile radius of a school identified as a persistently low-performing public school pursuant to Section 1002.333, F.S. A School of Hope may be located outside of a Florida Opportunity Zone or persistently low-performing school attendance zone in the nearest suitable underused, vacant or surplus facility if the district does not have such a facility available for the Hope Operator to use within a Florida Opportunity Zone or persistently low-performing school attendance zone. Students from persistently low-performing schools and students residing in a Florida Opportunity Zone shall be exempt from any enrollment lottery to the extent permitted by federal grant requirements. The School of Hope must be located in the same school district as the Notice of Intent is filed. To establish a School of Hope, the Hope Operator must:

(a) Complete form SOH2, School of Hope Notice of Intent (<http://www.flrules.org/Gateway/reference.asp?No=Ref-09076>), hereby incorporated by reference and effective February 2018.

(b) Complete the designated sections of form SOH3, School of Hope Performance-based Agreement (PBA) (<http://www.flrules.org/Gateway/reference.asp?No=Ref-09077>), hereby incorporated by reference and effective February 2018. The designated sections of form SOH3, School of Hope Performance-based Agreement, which are to be completed by the Hope Operator, are shaded and marked with brackets. Forms SOH2 and SOH3 may be obtained electronically on the Department of Education's website at <http://www.floridaschoolschoice.org> or from the Office of Independent Education and Parental Choice, Department of Education, 325 West Gaines Street, Tallahassee, Florida 32399-0400.

(c) At least four (4) months prior to the anticipated opening date, submit the completed Notice of Intent and School of Hope Performance-based Agreement forms to the Sponsor and, if the Sponsor is a Florida College System institution or state university, a Notice of Intent to the Superintendent of the

school district in which the persistently low-performing school has been identified by the Department. The forms shall be either hand delivered or sent certified mail with a return receipt requested. The entity shall provide a copy of the completed forms to the Department at the same time they are submitted to the Superintendent. The forms may be provided to the Department electronically or via regular mail at the address in subsection (11) of this rule.

(d) Within ten (10) business days of receipt of the Notice of Intent and School of Hope Performance-based Agreement forms, the school district shall notify the Hope Operator of any errors or omissions in the notice and PBA and afford the Hope Operator ten (10) business days to complete and resubmit the forms. Errors or omission of an element by a Hope Operator shall not provide a school district any relief from its obligation to enter a Performance-based Agreement unless identified as provided in this paragraph.

(e) Upon receipt of the Notice of Intent and PBA as provided in paragraph (d), the school district shall send the Hope Operator and the Department a notice of the date of receipt, which shall serve as the date when the sixty-day period to enter into a School of Hope Performance-based Agreement begins.

(4) Performance-Based Agreement. Upon receipt of a complete Notice of Intent and draft School of Hope Performance-based Agreement form from an entity that has been designated by the State Board of Education as a Hope Operator, the District shall enter into a performance-based agreement with the entity within sixty (60) days to open one or more public Schools of Hope to serve students from persistently low-performing schools.

(a) If the District proposes revisions to the Performance-based Agreement submitted by the Hope Operator, it shall indicate such proposed revisions with strike-through text for proposed deletions and underlined text for proposed additions. All proposed revisions must be consistent with the requirements in Section 1002.333(5), F.S.

(b) Upon execution of the performance-based agreement, the District shall provide a copy of the agreement to the entity and to the Department within ten (10) business days.

(c) If the District fails to enter into a performance-based agreement with the Hope Operator within sixty (60) days the district shall reduce the administrative fees withheld pursuant to Section 1002.33(20), F.S. as directed by Section 1002.333(8), F.S.

(d) The Hope Operator or school district may petition the State Board of Education for dispute resolution if the parties fail to enter into a PBA at least sixty (60) days after submission of the Notice of Intent pursuant to paragraph (7)(a) of this rule.

(e) The performance-based agreement may be amended if both parties mutually agree to the amended terms. The amended performance-based agreement must include the signatures of both parties.

(5) Underused, vacant or surplus facility reports and facility access.

(a) Vacant and Underused Facilities Report. By February 1 of each year, school districts must provide the Department with the following information pertaining to their underused, vacant or surplus facilities:

1. The number of classrooms, student stations and administrative spaces;
2. The number of full-time equivalent students;
3. Information such as size and capacity for shared spaces such as gym, cafeteria, auditorium; and
4. Any other available information regarding school building usage.

(b) In accordance with Section 1002.333(7)(d), F.S., the Department shall publish a final, corrected list of underused, vacant or surplus facilities by April 1 of each year.

(c) Floor Plans. The district shall provide floor plans via secure method for any underused, vacant or surplus facility to a Hope Operator that makes a request for such within ten (10) business days of receipt of the request.

(d) Facility Access. Each district must permit a Hope Operator access to any underused, vacant or surplus facility before or after regular school hours within five (5) business days from receipt of a Hope Operator's written request for purposes including:

1. To tour the facility in order to evaluate the facility's suitability for a School of Hope; and
2. For planning repairs, maintenance, renovations and other purposes on an ongoing basis associated with opening and maintaining a School of Hope. All personnel responsible for the repairs, maintenance, and renovations of the school building must undergo a Level 2 background screening pursuant to s. 435.04, F.S.

(e) For the purpose of identifying facilities for potential use or shared use by a School of Hope, a facility is deemed eligible if, at the time the School of Hope Building Notice is submitted, it meets at least one of the following:

1. A Facility Utilization Rate that is no more than 75 percent; or
2. A surplus of at least 400 student stations.

(f) A School of Hope may not co-locate at a facility that first received occupancy, or was first placed into service, within the previous four (4) years.

(6) Facility selection, space allocation, and use.

(a) Facility Use and Support Services. A district must permit a School of Hope to use underused, vacant or surplus district facilities and to receive facility-related services.

1. A Hope Operator that intends to submit a School of Hope Notice of Intent and locate a School of Hope in an underused, vacant or surplus facility shall submit a letter (the "School of Hope Building Notice") to the Superintendent of the district where the facility is located and a copy of that letter to the Department at least one year and no more than two years prior to the planned opening of the School of Hope. The letter shall include:

- a. The underused, vacant or surplus facility (along with proposed alternatives, at the Hope Operator's discretion) at which the Hope Operator wishes to locate the school;
- b. Projected SOH Enrollment for such facility;
- c. At the election of the Hope Operator, a preliminary proposal for space allocation within the building, taking into consideration the Projected SOH Seats;
- d. The identification of the applicable low-performing school or opportunity zone; and
- e. An attestation from the Hope Operator that the operator intends to open a School of Hope at the identified facility and the notice is not speculative or filed for the purpose of restricting access to available facilities. The attestation must include the following documentation:

(I) A governing board resolution authorizing the proposed site and affirming the intent to open at the facility; and

(II) A draft of the staffing and enrollment plan for the site that includes projected grade levels to be served and anticipated enrollment by grade. This draft must conform to a form prescribed by the Department.

The Building Notice may be submitted prior to the submission of a Notice of Intent. This paragraph shall not be deemed to invalidate any Building Notices that have already been accepted by a district.

2. A Hope Operator may not submit more than five (5) School of Hope Building Notices in a twelve (12) month period statewide. If a Hope Operator wishes to submit an additional notice, the Hope Operator must rescind a notice. If a Hope Operator submits more than five (5) Building Notices within a twelve (12) month period, the Department shall notify the Hope Operator and impacted districts. The Hope Operator shall have ten (10) calendar days from receiving such notice, to designate the five (5) Building Notices the Hope Operator intends to keep. If the Hope Operator does not respond to the Department, the most recent Building Notices that exceed the limit are nullified. Districts that receive

a Building Notice may request confirmation from the Department that the Hope Operator has complied with the limitations in this paragraph.

3. The district has twenty (20) business days from the date of submission to provide a written objection to a School of Hope Building Notice. Such written objection may propose an alternate facility for consideration by the Hope Operator, taking into consideration the Projected SOH Enrollment and proximity to the student population the Hope Operator seeks to serve. The Hope Operator is not required to accept the alternate facility. Without objection during twenty (20) business days from the date of submission, the choice is final unless later deemed by the Department to violate the limits set forth in subparagraph 2.

4. A district may only object to a School of Hope Building Notice due to material impracticability. Should two Hope Operators submit SOH Building Notices for the same space, the space shall be awarded to the first Hope Operator to submit their Building Notice.

5. A School of Hope Building Notice must not request a facility in which the Projected SOH enrollment exceeds the excess seats set forth in the most recent public reporting published by the Department.

6. Pursuant to s. 1002.333(9)(c)-(d), F.S., the school district must permit a School of Hope to have the practical and effective use of all or part of an educational facility at no cost, which includes both the ability to occupy space and operate within the facility and to receive facilities-related services, except as expressly provided in this rule. Further, students enrolled in the School of Hope shall be included in the district's total capital outlay full-time equivalent membership and for calculating any other maintenance funds for the facility. At the request of a School of Hope in a district-owned facility, the school district must provide the School of Hope with the same facilities-related services it provides to district-operated schools, in a manner agreed upon in the Mutual Management Plan, pursuant to paragraph (6)(c).

(b) Shared Facility Plan. Thirty (30) calendar days after the choice of underused, vacant or surplus facility is final, the Hope Operator and district must agree on a Shared Facility Plan, renewable annually, subject to amendment no later than sixty (60) calendar days before expiration of the annual term. The Shared Facility Plan must address the following:

1. Classroom Space and Administrative Space Allocation.

a. Proportionate Allocation. Classroom space, administrative space and storage space (including student lockers) in the facility must be allocated proportionately based on Projected SOH Enrollment and taking room size into consideration.

b. Contiguous Allocation. The district and Hope Operator must ensure that all schools in a building can operate in contiguous space. To the extent this requires that an existing school consolidate its operations, it must do so within ten (10) business days of the end of the prior school year.

2. Shared Common Space Usage. All common indoor and outdoor space at a facility such as cafeterias, gymnasiums, recreation areas, parking lots, storage spaces and auditoriums, without limitation, must be shared proportionately based on total full-time equivalent student enrollment. When it is necessary to schedule use of a space, space shall be scheduled proportionately such as by allowing each school to have proportional access to a cafeteria during traditional lunch hours.

(c) Mutual Management Plan. Thirty (30) calendar days after the choice of underused, vacant or surplus facility is final, the Hope Operator and district must agree on a Mutual Management Plan renewable annually, subject to amendment no later than sixty (60) calendar days before expiration of the annual term. The Mutual Management Plan shall ensure that the space to be used by the School of Hope complies with all safety and other requirements and is maintained as other facilities in the district and as necessary to meet the electrical needs of the School of Hope. District maintenance of space used by the School of Hope must be performed as timely and with as much care as other district space. If the district fails to provide space in this condition, it will reimburse the Hope Operator for

fees incurred for such maintenance and ensure building access for any workers providing such services.

1. The Mutual Management Plan must include an agreement between the Hope Operator and the district for the use of facility-related services requested by the Hope Operator, including but not limited to maintenance services, school safety services, student transportation services, custodial services, nursing services, and food related services. Consistent with subparagraph (6)(a)6., this paragraph outlines the circumstances under which a school district may charge a Hope Operator for facility-related services.

a. Districts may charge a Hope Operator for the additional incremental costs of utilities resulting directly from the use of such utilities by the Hope Operator.

b. If a Hope Operator elects to receive school safety services or student transportation services from the district, the Hope Operator shall remit to the district the full amount of any state allocations specifically designated for such services, including but not limited to funds distributed through the Florida Safe Schools Allocation and the Student Transportation Allocation.

c. If a Hope Operator elects to receive custodial services, nursing services, or food related services, the district may charge the Hope Operator for the additional incremental costs for such services resulting directly from use of such services by the Hope Operator.

d. The additional incremental costs associated in subparagraphs a. and c. shall exclude costs that the district would incur regardless of the Hope Operator's use of such services. The district must provide the Hope Operator with an estimate of the anticipated additional incremental costs applicable to the services provided to the Hope Operator. Upon request by the Hope Operator, the district must provide the methodology and supporting documentation used to calculate the district's actual, reasonable costs to provide such services to the Hope Operator.

e. The district and Hope Operator, in lieu of the costs calculated in subparagraph d., may agree to a fixed amount per student. The fixed amount shall be less than the estimated costs calculated in subparagraph d.

2. The Hope Operator and the district must agree on the additional incremental costs to be remitted to the school district by the Hope Operator; however, if the parties do not reach an agreement, the dispute shall be resolved pursuant to the dispute resolution provisions applicable to the Mutual Management Plan.

3. The Mutual Management Plan must require a School of Hope to comply with school safety requirements that are applicable to charter schools, including but not limited to emergency planning, security procedures, and school safety assessments. If the School of Hope is co-located with another school, the Mutual Management Plan must include coordination with the district's safety and emergency procedures for the shared campus, including access to control procedures, emergency drills and procedures, reunification plans, threat management coordination, and incident reporting. Nothing in the Mutual Management Plan requires disclosure of confidential or exempt information, as provided for in law.

(7) Dispute resolution between districts and Hope Operators relating to an SOH Building Notice, Shared Facility Plan, Mutual Management Plan, Performance Based Agreement or Annual Building Report.

(a) Either a district or Hope Operator may request that the Commissioner appoint a special magistrate to resolve a dispute relating to an SOH Building Notice, Shared Facility Plan, Mutual Management Plan, Performance Based Agreement or a contract between the district and Hope Operator under s. 1008.33, F.S. Such request shall be copied to the other party to the dispute and shall include an evidentiary submission. The Commissioner will appoint the special magistrate within twenty (20) days of the date of request.

(b) The non-initiating party may submit a response within twenty (20) calendar days of the special magistrate's appointment.

(c) The initiating party may then submit a reply within twenty (20) calendar days of the non-initiating party's filing or waive the right to do so.

(d) The special magistrate may hold an evidentiary hearing if necessary or decline to do so, within forty-five (45) calendar days of the special magistrate's appointment, and will submit its recommended order to the Commissioner within fifteen (15) calendar days of the date of the hearing or its decision not to hold one.

(e) The Commissioner shall provide a recommended order to the State Board of Education within fifteen (15) calendar days after receipt of the special magistrate's recommended order.

(f) The State Board of Education must approve or reject the recommended order at its next regular meeting that is more than eight (8) calendar days from the transmission of the recommended order.

(8) This rule does not create a legal right to a performance based agreement with the State Board of Education.

(9) School of Hope Funds. A School of Hope may only receive School of Hope funds after its first five (5) years of operation if the School of Hope meets the performance metrics outlined below. Funds received based upon performance may be used for any operational expenditures, including those associated with facility-related services paid to the school district.

(a) The Department shall calculate School Grades pursuant to s. 1008.34, F.S., and Rule 6A-1.09981, F.A.C. This data shall be used for determining eligibility for School of Hope funds beginning in the school's sixth year of operation and thereafter.

(b) A School of Hope shall initially qualify to receive School of Hope funds in its sixth year of operation or in a subsequent year of operation if, at any time during its most recent two years of operation:

1. It would have been in the top 7 percent of Title I-eligible district schools statewide of the same school type (i.e., elementary, middle, high, or combination) on the English Language Arts (ELA) Achievement component of School Grades, as defined in Rule 6A-1.09981, F.A.C., in at least one school year; and

2. It would have been in the top 7 percent of Title I-eligible district schools statewide of the same school type (i.e., elementary, middle, high, or combination) on the Mathematics Achievement component of School Grades, as defined in Rule 6A-1.09981, F.A.C., in at least one school year.

(c) The thresholds may be met in different school years within the two-year window.

(d) Continuation of Eligibility and Provisional Status.

1. Once a School of Hope meets the standard as described in paragraphs (b) and (c), it shall continue to receive School of Hope funds each subsequent school year unless it falls below the top 7 percent in either of the components listed in paragraph (b) in the most recent school year.

2. If the school falls below the top 7 percent in either of the components listed in paragraph (b) in the most recent school year, it shall be placed in provisional status for that component for the subsequent school year. A School of Hope in provisional status in a component remains eligible to receive School of Hope funds during the provisional status year.

3. Provisional status is tracked separately for each component and does not affect funding eligibility based on the other components.

(e) Loss and Reinstatement of Eligibility.

1. If the School of Hope fails to meet the top 7 percent standard in a component by the end of its provisional status school year for that component, it shall be ineligible to receive School of Hope funds for the following school year until it meets the standard in both components again in the same school year.

2. Regaining the standard in a component during a school year restores eligibility for that component for the subsequent school year, but funding will resume only when both components meet the standard in the same school year.

(f) Applicable Assessments. The applicable assessments are:

1. The grade 4 statewide standardized ELA reading and mathematics assessments for elementary schools.
2. The grade 7 statewide standardized ELA reading and mathematics assessments for middle schools.
3. The grade 10 statewide standardized ELA reading and the Algebra 1 end-of-course (EOC) assessment for high schools.

If the students of a high school generally take the Algebra 1 EOC assessment while enrolled in a middle school operated by the same Hope Operator, student performance on such exam at the middle school shall be used in place of high-school-level results on such exam for purposes of the high school's eligibility under this section.

(10) A Hope Operator shall have secure access to the student information system in the school district in which a School of Hope is located.

(11) Forms or documentation submitted to the Department should be submitted electronically to HopeSchools@fldoe.org or mailed to the Office of Independent Education and Parental Choice, 325 West Gaines Street, Suite 1044, Tallahassee, Florida, 32399.

Rulemaking Authority 1002.333(13) FS. Law Implemented 1002.333 FS. History—New 2-20-18, Amended 10-28-25, 3-26-26.

History of the Rule

[Source: https://flrules.org/gateway/ruleNo.asp?id=6A-1.0998271](https://flrules.org/gateway/ruleNo.asp?id=6A-1.0998271)

History of this Rule since Jan. 6, 2006

Notice / Adopted	Section	Description	ID	Publish Date
	Final 6A-1.0998271	Schools of Hope	30611083	Effective: 03/26/2026
	Change 6A-1.0998271	Schools of Hope	30471694	2/2/2026 Vol. 52/21
	Proposed 6A-1.0998271	This rule sets forth requirements for designation as a School of Hope operator and for establishment of Schools of Hope pursuant to s. 1002.333, F.S.	30468008	1/30/2026 Vol. 52/20
	Development 6A-1.0998271	This rule sets forth requirements for designation as a Schools of Hope operator pursuant to s. 1002.333, F.S. This proposed amendment will add further clarity to implement Senate Bill 2510 (2025), including criteria around	30397295	1/9/2026 Vol. 52/06
	Final 6A-1.0998271	Schools of Hope	30094461	Effective: 10/28/2025
	Correction 6A-1.0998271	Schools of Hope	30002408	9/19/2025 Vol. 51/183
	Proposed 6A-1.0998271	This rule sets forth requirements for designation as a School of Hope operator and for establishment of Schools of Hope pursuant to s. 1002.333, F.S.	29944596	9/3/2025 Vol. 51/171
	Development 6A-1.0998271	This rule sets forth requirements for designation as a Hope operator and for establishment of Schools of Hope pursuant to s. 1002.333, F.S. This proposed amendment will address changes to the program due to the passage of	29719556	7/7/2025 Vol. 51/130
	Final 6A-1.0998271	Schools of Hope	20037598	Effective: 02/20/2018
	Change 6A-1.0998271	Schools of Hope	19928667	1/8/2018 Vol. 44/05
	Correction 6A-1.0998271	Schools of Hope	19846411	12/18/2017 Vol. 43/242
	Proposed 6A-1.0998271	This new rule is necessary for the implementation and administration of the Schools of Hope program established in s. 1002.333, Florida Statutes. The rule will establish the process and criteria for non-profit charter school	19841464	12/15/2017 Vol. 43/241
	Development 6A-1.0998271	This rule is necessary for the implementation and administration of the Schools of Hope program established in s. 1002.333, Florida Statutes. The rule will establish the process and criteria for non-profit charter school	19583153	10/20/2017 Vol. 43/204
	Development 6A-1.0998271	This rule is necessary for the administration of the Schools of Hope program established in s. 1002.333, Florida Statutes. The rule will establish the process and criteria for non-profit charter school operators to apply	19170321	7/11/2017 Vol. 43/133

Schools of Hope Revolving Loan Fund Statute

Source:

https://www.leg.state.fl.us/statutes/index.cfm?App_mode=Display_Statute&Search_String=&URL=1000-1099/1001/Sections/1001.292.html

1001.292 Schools of Hope Revolving Loan Program.—

- (1) The Schools of Hope Revolving Loan Program is established within the Department of Education to provide assistance to hope operators, as defined in s. [1002.333](#), to meet school building construction needs and pay for expenses related to the startup of a new charter school. The program shall consist of funds appropriated by the Legislature, money received from the repayment of loans made from the program, and interest earned.
- (2) Funds provided pursuant to this section may not exceed 25 percent of the total cost of the project, which shall be calculated based on 80 percent of the cost per student station established by s. [1013.64](#)(6)(b) multiplied by the capacity of the facility.
- (3) The department may contract with a third-party administrator to administer the program. If the department contracts with a third-party administrator, funds shall be granted to the third-party administrator to create a revolving loan fund for the purpose of financing projects that meet the requirements of subsection (4). The third-party administrator shall report to the department annually. The department shall continue to administer the program until a third-party administrator is selected.
- (4) Hope operators that have been designated by the State Board of Education and have executed a performance-based agreement pursuant to s. [1002.333](#) shall be provided a loan of up to the amount provided in subsection (2) for projects that are located in the attendance area of a persistently low-performing school or within a 5-mile radius of such school and primarily serve students from the persistently low-performing school. A hope operator is not eligible for funding if it operates in facilities provided by the school district for a nominal fee, or at no charge, or if it is directly or indirectly operated by the school district.
- (5) The department shall post on its website the projects that have received loans, the geographic distribution of the projects, the status of the projects, the costs of the program, and student outcomes for students enrolled in the school of hope receiving funds.
- (6) All repayments of principal and interest shall be returned to the loan fund and made available for loans to other applicants. Beginning July 1, 2027, when the funds of the Schools of Hope program established in s. [1002.333](#) fall below \$25 million, the third-party administrator shall transfer from the loan fund to the program an amount that provides for maintaining a balance of \$25 million in the program.
- (7) Interest on loans provided under this program may be used to defray the costs of administration and shall be the lower of:
 - (a) The rate paid on moneys held in the fund; or
 - (b) A rate equal to 50 percent of the rate authorized under the provisions of s. [215.84](#).
- (8) Notwithstanding s. [216.301](#) and pursuant to s. [216.351](#), funds allocated for this purpose which are not disbursed by June 30 of the fiscal year in which the funds are allocated may be carried forward for up to 5 years after the effective date of the original appropriation.

History.—s. 44, ch. 2017-116; s. 2, ch. 2025-203.

Schools of Hope Revolving Loan Fund History/ Payment Ledger

Source:

<https://www.fldoe.org/schools/school-choice/other-school-choice-options/schools-of-hope/loan-fund.html>

Revolving Loan Fund

The purpose of the Schools of Hope Revolving Loan Program is to provide assistance to Schools of Hope operators to meet building construction needs and pay for expenses related to the startup of a new charter school. The program shall consist of funds appropriated by the Legislature money received from the repayment of loans made from the program, and interest earned.

The Legislature has to date appropriated \$100 million to the Revolving Loan Fund. The Department has selected Building Hope as the third-party administrator for the Fund.

The following payments have been made to Hope operators:

- IDEA Public Schools — \$7,969,479, in September 2020, for its location at 5050 10th Avenue, Tampa, Florida
- IDEA Public Schools — \$8,152,777, in March 2021, for its location at 11612 N. Nebraska Avenue, Tampa, Florida
- IDEA Public Schools — \$8,155,501, in March 2021, for its location at 1845 Bassett Road, Jacksonville, Florida
- IDEA Public Schools — \$8,155,501, in May 2021, for its location at 2354 University Boulevard, Jacksonville, Florida
- IDEA Public Schools — \$8,155,501, in February 2022, for its location at Lenox and Lane avenues, Jacksonville, Florida
- KIPP Miami — \$9,835,470, in March 2022, for its location at 11380 Northwest 27th Avenue, Miami, Florida (Miami-Dade College – North Campus)
- IDEA Public Schools — \$7,715,788, in April 2022, for its future location at 10414 Hart Pond Road, Thonotosassa, Florida
- IDEA Public Schools — \$9,280,594, in June 2022, for its future location at 625 Reynolds Road, Lakeland, Florida
- IDEA Public Schools — \$9,280,594, in July 2022, for its future location at 4949 Blanding Boulevard, Jacksonville, Florida
- Mater Academy — \$9,418,258, in December 2022, for its location at 230-260 Southwest 7th Road, Miami, Florida
- KIPP Miami — \$10,460,997, in January 2024, for its location at 1080 Northwest 79th Street, Miami, Florida
- RCMA — \$2,349,548, in July 2024, for its location at 4440 Academy Drive, Mulberry, Florida
- Total Revolving Loan Fund payments: \$98,930,008